



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



THIS WEEK'S MENU

Southwest Chicken Burritos

with Black Bean Salsa

blackened chicken, black bean salsa, cilantro-lime rice, romaine lettuce, cilantro-lime crema, cheddar cheese

Crunchwrap Supremes

with Chicken Tinga

chicken tinga, cheddar cheese, tostadas, cilantro-lime crema, romaine lettuce, cherry tomatoes

Taco Salad

with Chipotle Dressing

romaine lettuce, cherry tomatoes, black bean salsa, chicken tinga, crispy tortilla strips, cilantro-lime crema, chipotle dressing, cotija

Elote Shrimp Tacos

with Elote Pico

blackened shrimp, romaine lettuce, elote pico, lime, cilantro-lime rice (on the side)

Burrito Bowls

with Cilantro-Lime Rice

cilantro-lime rice, black beans, chicken tinga, elote pico, cotija, romaine lettuce, cherry tomatoes, chipotle dressing, cilantro-lime crema



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Limes (4)¹²³⁴⁵
- Shallot (2 large)¹²³⁴⁵
- Garlic (2 cloves)²³⁵
- Cherry Tomatoes (12 oz)²³⁵
- Romaine Lettuce (3 hearts)¹²³⁴⁵
- Cilantro (1 bunch)¹²³⁴⁵
- Jalapeños (1)¹³⁴⁵
- Red Bell Pepper (1)¹³⁴⁵

Shelf-Stable Goods

- Chipotle Peppers in Adobo Sauce (7 oz)²³⁵
- Crushed Fire-Roasted Tomatoes (14.5 oz)²³⁵
- 2 (15 oz) cans Black Beans¹³⁵
- Corn Tortillas (10-11)²³⁴
- Burrito-Size Flour Tortillas (6-7)¹²³
- Long-Grain White Rice (1.5 cups)¹⁴⁵

Frozen Vegetables

- Fire-Roasted Corn (12 oz)¹³⁴⁵

Dairy & Cheeses

- Greek Yogurt ($\frac{2}{3}$ cup or 150 g)¹²³⁵
- Extra Sharp Cheddar (8-9 oz)¹²
- Cotija (10 oz)³⁴⁵

Suggested Proteins

- Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts
(4-5 x 8-10 oz breasts)¹²³⁵
- Medium Shrimp (12-14)⁴

KEY

- ¹ = Southwest Chicken Burritos
- ² = Crunchwrap Supremes
- ³ = Taco Salad
- ⁴ = Elote Shrimp Tacos
- ⁵ = Burrito Bowls



ESSENTIALS

& TIME SAVERS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil³⁵
- Neutral Oil¹²³⁴⁵
- Full-Fat Mayonnaise⁴⁵

Acid & Vinegars

- Red Wine Vinegar³⁵

Spices & Aromatics

- Ground Allspice¹⁴⁵
- Chili Powder²³⁵
- Ground Cumin¹⁴⁵
- Dried Oregano¹⁴⁵
- Garlic Powder¹⁴⁵
- Onion Powder¹⁴⁵
- Paprika¹⁴⁵

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³⁴⁵
- White Cane Sugar¹²³⁵
- Brown Sugar¹⁴⁵
- Honey³⁵

Time Savers

Produce

- Pre-cut & washed Romaine Lettuce

Grains

- Pre-cooked Rice

Other

- Tostadas
- Tortilla Strips

KEY

¹ = Southwest Chicken Burritos

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PREP LIST



KEY

- ¹ = Southwest Chicken Burritos
- ² = Crunchwrap Supremes
- ³ = Taco Salad
- ⁴ = Elote Shrimp Tacos
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 = used in "prepped ingredient"

 = estimated time

Green = keep out during prep

- Cook 2 cups of long-grain rice (rinse & strain rice, add it to a saucepan, add 3.5 cups of water, bring to a rolling boil, stir, cover, and simmer for 20 minutes) 
- Prepare Blackened Seasoning (see PDF 'Blackened Seasoning')¹⁴ 
- Prepare Produce ( 30 minutes)
 - Lettuce (3 hearts; thinly slice, wash, and dry)¹²³⁴⁵
 - Bell Pepper (1; finely dice) 
 - Jalapeño (1; finely dice) 
 - Cilantro (1 bunch; finely chop) 
 - Garlic (2 cloves; peel) 
 - Shallots (1; finely dice | 1; thinly slice) 
- Crumble ½ block (5 oz) of Cotija³⁴⁵ 
- Grate Extra-Sharp Cheddar¹²

CLEANING BREAK

- Strain & rinse 1 can of black beans (for Bean Salsa) 
- Prepare Tinga Sauce (see PDF 'Tinga Braising Sauce')²³⁵
- Cook Elote Pico & Black Bean Salsa Base (refer to Substack 'Mise En Place') 
- Prepare Cilantro-Lime Rice (see PDF 'Cilantro-Lime Rice')¹⁴⁵
- Prepare Sauces ( 30 minutes)
 - Black Bean Salsa (see PDF 'Black Bean Salsa')¹³
 - Elote Pico (see PDF 'Elote Pico')⁴⁵
 - Cilantro-Lime Crema (see PDF 'Cilantro-Lime Crema')¹²³⁵
 - Chipotle Dressing (see PDF 'Chipotle Dressing')³⁵
- Prepare Corn Tortillas
 - 2; Tostadas²
 - 2-3; Crispy Tortilla Strips³

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

- Open & transfer the final can of black beans to an air-tight container & put away (to use throughout the week)⁵
- Chicken Breasts (1; slice in half lengthwise)¹
- Prepare Chicken Tinga (3-4 Chicken Breasts, see PDF 'Crunchwrap Supremes')²³⁵
 - Store braised chicken in airtight container in the refrigerator/freezer until needed. If freezing be sure to thaw in the refrigerator overnight before use. (recommend freezing 1 portion for meal 5)



SOUTHWEST CHICKEN BURRITOS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Blackened Seasoning (Page 12)¹⁴

Cilantro-Lime Rice (Page 7)^{14s}

Cilantro-Lime Crema (Page 10)^{123s}

Black Bean Salsa (Page 8)¹³

Blackened Chicken

1 large Chicken Breast, sliced in half lengthwise

Blackened Seasoning

Neutral Oil

Southwest Burritos

½ cup Cilantro-Lime Rice

½ cup Black Bean Salsa

2 Burrito-size (large) Flour Tortillas

Cilantro-Lime Crema

Shredded Romaine Lettuce

Cheddar Cheese

Instructions

Prepare Chicken

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F.
2. Season the **chicken breast** with a couple generous pinches of **blackened seasoning**, covering the surface area of both chicken halves.
3. Preheat a shallow frying pan on high heat. Lightly coat the bottom of the pan with **neutral oil**.
4. Add seasoned chicken breast and sear for 4-5 minutes, or until slightly golden. Flip the chicken, and continue searing for another 3-4 minutes. Transfer chicken to a sheet tray and finish cooking in the oven for an additional 6-7 minutes, or until chicken reaches 165°F internally.
5. Allow chicken to rest for 5 minutes before cutting into small dice.

Build the Burritos

1. Heat 1-2 tsp of neutral oil in a pan over high heat.
2. Add **cilantro-lime rice** and cook until fully reheated. Transfer to a bowl and set aside.
3. In the same pan, add **black bean salsa** and cook until reheated. Transfer to a bowl and set aside.
4. Place **tortillas** directly over a medium-high flame, flipping constantly (to prevent burning) OR place in a large pan to heat until soft (around 2-3 minutes).
5. Place warmed tortillas on a flat surface. Add diced blackened chicken, cilantro-lime rice, black bean salsa, **cilantro-lime crema**, **romaine lettuce**, and **cheese**.
6. Bring the bottom of the tortilla up and over all ingredients. Tuck the folded-over edge around the filling, tuck in both sides, and then roll the burrito closed.
7. **Optional:** Heat 1-2 tsp of neutral oil in a large pan on medium-high heat. Add burritos (folded side down first). Cook on both sides for 30 seconds, or until golden brown. Slice and serve.

CRUNCHWRAP SUPREMES

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Tinga Braising Sauce (Page 6)^{23s}

Cilantro-Lime Crema (Page 10)^{123s}

Crunchwrap Supreme

Neutral Oil

3-4 Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts*

Kosher Salt

Tinga Braising Sauce

3 Burrito-size (large) Flour Tortillas

Cheddar Cheese

2 Tostadas

Cilantro-Lime Crema

Shredded Romaine Lettuce

7-8 Cherry Tomatoes, halved

*We're making a triple batch of chicken tinga, since we'll be using the leftovers throughout the week. Store the remaining chicken in an air-tight container in the refrigerator.

Instructions

Prepare the Chicken

1. Heat a large, heavy-bottomed pot with a thin layer of **neutral oil** on high heat.
2. Pat **chicken breasts** dry and season with a few generous pinches of **salt**.
3. Once the oil is hot, add chicken and sear for 3-4 minutes. Flip and cover with all of the **tinga braising sauce**. Cover, reduce heat to low, and cook for 30 minutes, or until the chicken falls apart easily.
4. Once the chicken is done cooking, shred it using a stand mixer or 2 forks.

Prepare Crunchwraps

1. Cut 1 **flour tortilla** into 2 taco-sized rounds.
2. Place the remaining 2 tortillas directly over a medium-high flame, flipping constantly (to prevent burning) OR place in a large pan to heat until soft (around 2-3 minutes).
3. Place warmed tortillas on a flat surface. Layer with shredded chicken (strained), a handful of **cheese**, a **tostada**, a thin layer of **cilantro-lime crema**, **shredded romaine**, and **halved cherry tomatoes**. Top with the previously cut taco-sized rounds and fold the edges of the large tortilla in towards the center, creating pleats.
4. In a large skillet, heat 1-2 tsp of neutral oil over medium-high heat. Add crunchwrap, seam-side down and cook until golden brown. Flip and cook for an additional 2-3 minutes.
5. Slice in half and serve.

TACO SALAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Chicken Tinga (Page 2 - Prepared w Tinga Braising Sauce pg 6)^{23s}

Black Bean Salsa (Page 8)¹³

Chipotle Dressing (Page 9)^{3s}

Cilantro-Lime Crema (Page 10)^{123s}

1 ½ cups (or 2 servings) Chicken Tinga

2 Burrito-sized (large) Flour Tortillas

3-4 large handfuls of Shredded Romaine Lettuce

10-12 Cherry Tomatoes, halved

Cotija

1 cup Black Bean Salsa

Chipotle Dressing, *to taste*

Kosher Salt

Cilantro-Lime Crema, *to taste*

Crispy Tortilla Strips

Instructions

Reheat Chicken

1. Place 2 servings worth of **chicken tinga** in a saucepan over medium-high heat. Cook until fully reheated, stirring occasionally (around 8 minutes).

Build Salad & Serve

1. In a large mixing bowl, toss together **shredded romaine, tomatoes, black bean salsa, cotija, chipotle dressing** and a pinch of **salt**.
2. Place **flour tortillas** directly over a medium-high flame, flipping constantly (to prevent burning) OR place in a large pan to heat until soft (around 2-3 minutes).
3. **For A Tortilla Base:** Plate warmed tortillas your preferred plate or shallow bowl. Plate tossed salad directly over each warmed tortilla. Top with reheated chicken tinga, **cilantro-lime crema** and **crispy tortilla strips**.
4. **For A Tortilla On The Side:** Plate tossed salad and top with reheated chicken tinga, **cilantro-lime crema** and **crispy tortilla strips**. Fold warmed tortillas into triangles and serve on the side.

ELOTE SHRIMP TACOS

Makes 4-5 tacos

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Blackened Seasoning (Page 12)¹⁴

Elote Pico (Page 11)⁴⁵

Cilantro-Lime Rice (Page 7)¹⁴⁵

Blackened Shrimp

12-14 medium Shrimp, thawed (if frozen), shelled & deveined

Blackened Seasoning

Neutral Oil

Tacos

Shredded Romaine Lettuce

Kosher Salt

1 Lime, cut into 4 wedges

4-5 Corn Tortillas

Elote Pico

Cotija

1 ½ cup Cilantro-Lime Rice, reheated*

*reheat your rice in the microwave or in a pan with 1-2 tsp of neutral oil.

Instructions

Cook Shrimp

1. If frozen, thaw **shrimp** under cold water and pat down with a paper towel until dry.
2. Place shrimp in a mixing bowl and season generously with **blackened seasoning**. Shrimp should be fully coated in seasoning.
3. Heat 2-3 Tbsp of **neutral oil** in a large skillet over high heat.
4. Add shrimp and cook for 5-6 minutes, flipping halfway.

Assemble and Serve Tacos

1. While shrimp cooks, combine **romaine**, a pinch of **salt**, and the juice of **2 lime wedges** in a clean mixing bowl.
2. Once the shrimp is finished cooking, transfer it to a plate and clean the skillet with a paper towel.
3. Heat the clean skillet on high heat. Add **tortillas** and cook for 1 minute on each side. Transfer to a plate.
4. Top each tortilla with a handful of the romaine, followed by about 3 cooked shrimp, a dollop of **elote pico**, and a sprinkle of **cotija**. Garnish each plate with **1 lime wedge (each)**.
5. Serve with a side of reheated **cilantro-lime rice**.

BURRITO BOWLS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Chicken Tinga (Page 2 Prepared w Tinga Braising Sauce pg 6)^{23s}

Chipotle Dressing (Page 9)^{3s}

Cilantro-Lime Rice (Page 7)^{14s}

Elote Pico (Page 11)^{4s}

Cilantro-Lime Crema (Page 10)^{123s}

Burrito Bowls

Remaining Chicken Tinga

Shredded Romaine Lettuce

8-10 Cherry Tomatoes, halved

Chipotle Dressing

Kosher Salt

Cilantro-Lime Rice, reheated*

15 oz can Black Beans, strained & reheated*

Elote Pico

Cilantro-Lime Crema

Cotija

Instructions

Reheat Chicken and Build Burrito Bowls

1. Place **chicken tinga** in a medium saucepan on medium-high heat and cook until fully reheated, stirring occasionally (around 8 minutes).
2. In a medium mixing bowl, toss **shredded romaine, cherry tomatoes, chipotle dressing**, and a small pinch of **salt** (dress to your liking). Set aside.
3. Plate **cilantro-lime rice** and top with **black beans** and chicken tinga.
4. Top with **elote pico, cilantro-lime crema**, and **cotija** and serve.

TINGA BRAISING SAUCE

Makes about 6 ½ to 7 cups

Ingredients

2 Tbsp (16 g) Neutral Oil
1 Shallot, thinly sliced
2 cloves of Garlic, roughly chopped or sliced
1 tsp (4 g) Chili Powder
7-8 Chipotle Peppers in Adobo Sauce¹
4 Tbsp (60 g) Adobo Sauce
14.5 oz can (411 g) Crushed Fire-Roasted Tomatoes
3 ½ cups (840 g) Water
4 tsp (16 g) Kosher Salt²
1 Tbsp (15 g) White Sugar

NOTES:

¹ - Use all but 1 chipotle pepper - if you're sensitive to spice, use half.

² - If you have it, I recommend substituting

2 tsp of Chicken Bouillon for around half of the Kosher Salt (1 ½ tsp or 5 g) to add a depth of flavor.

Instructions

1. In a saucepan, heat **neutral oil** over medium heat. Add **shallot** and sauté until translucent (around 3-4 minutes). Add **garlic** and **chili powder** and cook for around 1 minute, or until fragrant and slightly toasted.
2. Add **chipotle peppers, adobo sauce, crushed tomatoes, water, salt, and sugar**. Stir.
3. Reduce heat to low and simmer for 15 minutes.
4. Remove from heat and allow braising liquid to cool. Blend until the sauce is smooth.

To Store: Transfer the braising sauce to an airtight container and store in the refrigerator.

CILANTRO-LIME RICE



Makes about 4 cups

Ingredients

1 ½ cups Long Grain White Rice, rinsed & strained

3 ¼ cups (g) Water

1 tsp (5 g) Kosher Salt + a generous pinch

2 heaping Tbsp (10 g) chopped Cilantro

Juice of 1 Lime

Instructions

1. Place rinsed **rice**, **water**, and **1 tsp salt** in a large saucepan and bring to a boil on medium-high heat.
2. Once the water comes to a rolling boil, stir once, reduce the heat to low/simmer, cover with a lid, and cook for 20 minutes.
3. After 20 minutes, turn off the heat completely and allow rice to sit, **covered**, for an additional 10 minutes.
4. Transfer cooked rice to a mixing bowl. Add **cilantro**, **lime juice** and a generous pinch of **salt**. Mix until well combined.

To Store: Allow rice to cool before transferring to an air-tight container and storing in the refrigerator.

BLACK BEAN SALSA

Makes about 2 cups

Ingredients

Neutral Oil

½ large shallot, finely diced

6 oz (170 g) Fire-Roasted Corn

½ Bell Pepper, finely diced

½ tsp (1 g) Kosher Salt + a small pinch

15 oz can of Black Beans, strained & rinsed

½ tsp (1 g) Ground Cumin

2 Tbsp (8 g) chopped Cilantro

½ Jalapeño, finely diced

Juice of ½ Lime

Instructions

1. Heat 1-2 tablespoons of **neutral oil** in a pan over medium heat. Add **shallot** and cook until translucent (around 2-3 minutes).
2. Add **fire-roasted corn, bell pepper**, and **a small pinch of salt**. Sauté until slightly softened, but still tender (around 2-3 minutes). Transfer to a large mixing bowl.
3. Add **black beans, ½ tsp salt, cumin, cilantro, jalapeño**, and **lime juice**. Stir until well combined.

To Store: Place in an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

CHIPOTLE DRESSING

Makes about $\frac{2}{3}$ cup

Ingredients

1 Chipotle Pepper in Adobo Sauce
2 Tbsp (30 g) Adobo Sauce
 $\frac{1}{3}$ cup (75 g) Neutral Oil
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup (50 g) Olive Oil
2 Tbsp (35 g) Red Wine Vinegar
1 Tbsp (15 g) Honey
1 $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp (4 g) Salt
 $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp (<1 g) Dried Oregano

Instructions

1. Blend **all ingredients** until smooth and fully combined.

To Store: Transfer to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

CILANTRO-LIME CREMA

Makes $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

3 Tbsp (15 g) Chopped Cilantro

$\frac{2}{3}$ cup (150 g) Greek Yogurt

Zest of 1 Lime

Juice of 1 Lime (17 g)

2 Tbsp (30 g) Water

$\frac{1}{2}$ tsp (2 g) White Sugar

$\frac{3}{4}$ tsp (4 g) Salt

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a bowl and whisk until fully combined.

To Store: Transfer to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

ELOTE PICO

Makes 2 cups

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Blackened Seasoning (Page 12)¹⁴

Neutral Oil

½ large shallot, finely diced

6 oz (170 g) Fire-Roasted Corn

½ Bell Pepper, finely diced

Kosher Salt

1 ½ tsp (6 g) Blackened Seasoning

2 Tbsp (8 g) chopped Cilantro

½ cup (75 g) Cotija

Juice of ½ Lime (20 g)

½ Jalapeño, finely diced

1 Tbsp (10 g) Mayonnaise

Instructions

1. Heat 1-2 tablespoons of **neutral oil** in a pan over medium heat. Add **shallot** and cook until translucent (around 2-3 minutes).
2. Add **fire-roasted corn**, **bell pepper**, and **a small pinch of salt**. Sauté until slightly softened, but still tender (around 2-3 minutes). Transfer to a large mixing bowl and cool until mixture reaches room temperature (place in the refrigerator to speed this process up).
3. Once cooled, add **blackened seasoning**, **cilantro**, **cotija**, **lime juice**, **jalapeño**, and **mayonnaise**.

To Store: Place in an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

BLACKENED SEASONING

Makes ¼ cup

Ingredients

4 tsp (22 g) Brown Sugar
1 ½ tsp (2 g) Dried Oregano
1 tsp (3 g) Garlic Powder
1 tsp (2 g) Onion Powder
½ tsp (<1 g) Ground Allspice
2 tsp (4 g) Paprika
1 tsp (2 g) Cumin
2 tsp (6 g) Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. Combine **all ingredients** in a small mixing bowl.

To Store: Transfer to an air-tight container and store in the pantry for later use.